

The Bag

Every state a daemon can be in, every item that ends one, and the argument for each word. **36 items are renamed**, and this page is generated from the game's own table — the shipped description is quoted, not retyped.

The rule these names follow

A name has to work twice — once as the thing in your hand and once as the thing in a computer — and if it only works once it does not ship. That test is why PATCH was instant and CACHE was refused: a patch stops a leak and patches software, while a cache needs a beat of explanation before it means anything.

The description carries a second rule, added when the state items were rewritten: **teach the term in the first clause, state the effect in the second.**

“Preemption takes control back from a process that will not yield. Ends HUNG.”

The player who knows the word gets a nod; the player who does not gets a definition and never notices being taught.

The states

Vanilla leaves a creature poisoned, asleep, paralysed, burned, frozen or confused. Every one of those is a metaphor about a *body*, and this world does not have bodies — it has processes. A state is something a process is in, and something it can be got out of.

The three-letter code is what the party menu draws on a coloured tile, and what the battle box prints beside the name. The colours keep vanilla's hue anchors — a player who has ever seen a party menu reads orange as burning before they read the letters — and move into the muted register the type chart uses.

VANILLA	OURS	TILE	WHY IT IS THE EXACT WORD
POISON · PSN	LEAKING	LEK	A memory leak degrades a running process a little at a time until it dies. Nothing else in computing loses you a fixed slice per tick.
TOXIC · TOX	CASCADING	CAS	Badly poisoned worsens each turn, and a cascading failure is precisely a fault whose rate rises because of the damage it already did. It shares LEAKING's tile: Gen 3 has one poison slot and draws both in it.
SLEEP · SLP	SUSPENDED	SUS	Not gone, not scheduled, and it <i>resumes</i> . The one status that is genuinely temporary, and the word says so. The tile is slate: dormant rather than damaged.
PARALYSIS · PAR	THROTTLED	THR	Paralysis does two things — cuts speed, sometimes skips a turn. Throttling is a speed cap that intermittently stalls work. Both halves, one word.
BURN · BRN	OVERHEATED	OVR	Chip damage plus reduced output, dealt by ENTROPY, whose one-clause test is <i>noise and heat</i> . The tile is ember: heat the daemon made itself.
FREEZE · FRZ	HUNG	HNG	A hung process does nothing until something intervenes. FROZEN could not be reused — it is a type name, and the chart had just spent real effort making type names carry meaning. WATCHDOG is what ends it.

VANILLA	OURS	TILE	WHY IT IS THE EXACT WORD
CONFUSION	THRASHING	–	A system so busy managing itself it makes no progress and damages its own throughput. Hurting yourself in confusion is the same event. Volatile, so it needs no code.
FAINT	HALTED	HLT	The first of the seven, and the one that set the register for the rest: a state is something a process is <i>in</i> , and something it can be got out of.

CASCADING shares LEAKING's tile because Gen 3 draws badly-poisoned in the same box as ordinary poison. THRASHING needs no code at all: it is volatile, so it never reaches the party screen.

The operations that end a state

Vanilla's cures are sprays and medicines. Ours are the operations you would actually perform on a process that was in that state.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
ANTIDOTE	PATCH <i>A patch stops a leak at its source. Ends LEAKING, and the worse CASCADING with it.</i>	You patch a leak and you patch software. The pun is the definition — it needs no beat of confusion, which is the test CACHE was held to and failed.
AWAKENING	RESUME <i>Puts a SUSPENDED daemon back on the schedule. It was never gone, only unscheduled.</i>	The exact inverse of SUSPENDED, and the word an operating system uses for it.
PARLYZ HEAL	PRIORITY <i>Scheduled ahead of whatever was starving it. Ends THROTTLED.</i>	What lifts throttling is not medicine — it is being scheduled ahead of the thing starving you. <i>The weakest of the ten on the works-twice test, and kept because the mechanic is right.</i>
BURN HEAL	COOLANT <i>Draws off the heat a daemon made itself. Ends OVERHEATED.</i>	The only one of the seven that needs no domain knowledge at all. Plain, physical, and exactly right.
ICE HEAL	WATCHDOG <i>A watchdog notices a process that stopped answering, and resets it. Ends HUNG.</i>	Renamed twice, and the second time was the one that mattered. INTERRUPT shipped here and collided with the flute, which had taken the word six weeks earlier and keeps it. PREEMPT replaced it and collided with MANKEY, named four days before. <i>Under both collisions was a plainer fault: preempting a hung task hands the processor to somebody else and the hung one stays hung.</i> A watchdog is the timer whose whole job is to notice a process has stopped answering and reset it — the actual cure, and it still works twice.
FULL HEAL	ROLLBACK <i>Rolls back to a known-good state. Ends every state at once, whatever it was.</i>	Clears every state by returning to a known-good one. Says <i>all of it</i> without listing anything.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
HEAL POWDER	HOTFIX <i>Bitter, cheap, and it works now. Clears every state.</i>	Bitter, cheap, works now, nobody is proud of it. All four are true of both meanings.
FULL RESTORE	SNAPSHOT <i>Restores a DAEMON whole: health and state together.</i>	Health and state together, because that is what a snapshot restores. The one cure that is a noun for a thing you saved earlier.
REVIVE	RESTART <i>Starts a HALTED daemon again with half its health. It does not remember stopping.</i>	The word for bringing back a halted process — and it lands on HALTED without explaining itself.
MAX REVIVE	REBOOT <i>Brings back a HALTED daemon at full health.</i>	Strictly bigger than a restart, which is exactly the relationship the two items have. The ladder is free.

The hosts

The ladder is not sizes. It is **rights** — and a box is a little machine that a daemon agrees, or does not agree, to run on.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
POKé BALL	USERBOX <i>A host offered at user level. A steady daemon will run on it. A stubborn one will not.</i>	A box is not a container, it is a host. The ladder is not sizes, it is <i>rights</i> — and that is the argument: what you are doing when you bind a daemon is offering it an account on a machine.
GREAT BALL	ADMINBOX <i>A host with wider rights than a USERBOX. More daemons will agree to run on it.</i>	Wider rights than a USERBOX, so more daemons agree to run on it.
ULTRA BALL	SUPERBOX <i>A host with elevated rights. Most daemons will run on it, including reluctant ones.</i>	Elevated rights. Most daemons will run on it.
MASTER BALL	ROOTBOX <i>A host with unrestricted rights. No daemon can decline to run on it. Nothing is refused root.</i>	Unrestricted rights. <i>No daemon can decline</i> — which is the one place in the ladder where the metaphor turns unpleasant, and it is supposed to.
SAFARI BALL	GUESTBOX <i>A temporary host, issued at the gate and expiring at the gate. Its rights are minimal.</i>	Issued at the gate and expiring at the gate. A guest account is exactly a temporary host with a revocation date.

The one-trick balls keep vanilla's shape and become one-trick boxes — NET BOX, DIVE BOX, NEST BOX, REPEAT BOX, TIMER BOX, LUXURY BOX, PREMIER BOX. The ladder already carries the argument, and a second argument competing with it would blunt both.

The four inputs

Vanilla's evolution stones are four elements. Ours are four things you can give a mind, and each changes what some daemons compile to.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
FIRE STONE	AXIOM <i>Something for a mind to reason from. Some daemons take a new form when given one.</i>	The four inputs to a mind, not four elements. An axiom is something to reason <i>from</i> — you do not derive it, you start there.
THUNDERSTONE	EMBEDDING <i>A representation a mind can search through. Some daemons take a new form when given one.</i>	A representation you can search through. The one of the four that names a technique rather than a faculty, and the only one a player may already know.
WATER STONE	AFFECT <i>Something for a mind to feel with. Some daemons take a new form when given one.</i>	Something to feel with. <i>Affect</i> is the clinical word, which keeps it from reading as sentiment.
LEAF STONE	REWARD <i>A signal a mind can learn from. Some daemons take a new form when given one.</i>	A signal to learn from. Reward is the one of the four the whole game is arguing about and it is never said again.

The key items

One of these is a crime scene the player carries from minute fifteen, and nothing points at it.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
OAK'S PARCEL	CC-7 <i>A sealed module. Part no. CC-7. Addressed to CRYSTAL CLEAR. Not to you.</i>	<i>A sealed module. Part no. CC-7.</i> The number goes in the item name rather than the description, so the player carries it for thirty hours before reading a requisition for the same part on a door.
POKé FLUTE	INTERRUPT <i>Sends an interrupt. A daemon that has stopped responding will wake.</i>	An interrupt is a signal that reaches something which has stopped responding. A flute that wakes a sleeping obstacle is that, in the plainest sense.
SILPH SCOPE	RESOLVER <i>Resolves a name that will not resolve on its own. Some things cannot be identified without it.</i>	Resolves a name that will not resolve on its own. DNS said as a ghost story.
FAME CHECKER	HEARSAY <i>Holds what you were told about people, and who told you. It does not check anything.</i>	Holds what you were <i>told</i> , and who told you. It does not hold what is true — the item is a citation index, and the name admits it.
TEACHY TV	STREAM <i>A stream is data read as it arrives. This one carries the TUTOR, and a show per MARK.</i>	A stream is a broadcast and a stream is a sequence you read from as it arrives. <i>MACHINE STREAM was measured out before taste got a vote:</i> the name budget is thirteen characters and that one is fourteen.
OLD AMBER	OLD CORE <i>A core recovered whole. It holds a daemon that stopped a very long time ago.</i>	A core recovered whole, holding a daemon that stopped a very long time ago. The museum's whole argument, carried in the bag.
HELIX FOSSIL	HELIX CORE <i>A core found at Deadstack. Wound in a spiral. Nothing has read its contents.</i>	Wound in a spiral. Nothing has read its contents.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
DOME FOSSIL	DRUM CORE <i>A core found at Deadstack. A drum, sealed at both ends. Nothing has read its contents.</i>	A drum, sealed at both ends. Nothing has read its contents.

And one number

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
PP UP	MP UP <i>Slightly raises the maximum MP of a selected move for one DAEMON.</i>	PP is <i>power points</i> , which is a body word. MP is what the rest of the genre already calls the same number, and it costs one letter.
PP MAX	MP MAX <i>Raises the MP of a selected move to its maximum level for one DAEMON.</i>	Same change, same reason.

What the budget actually is

ITEM NAME	DESCRIPTION	RENAMED SO FAR
13 characters <i>ITEM_NAME_LENGTH is 14 including the terminator. MACHINE_STREAM is 14 and does not fit.</i>	3 lines <i>Roughly 30 characters each, measured in pixels rather than letters — the face is variable width.</i>	36 items <i>Derived by diffing our table against upstream's, which is the only way to tell a rename from an addition.</i>

Three that were harder than they look

One item was named three times, and each collision hid the next.

INTERRUPT was assigned twice six weeks apart — to the flute, and to ICE HEAL in the state pass. The flute keeps it, because waking a thing that blocks a road is an interrupt in the plainest sense. ICE HEAL became PREEMPT, which collided with MANKEY, named four days earlier.

Under both collisions was a plainer fault that nobody had looked for: preempting a hung task hands the processor to somebody else and the hung one stays hung. A watchdog is the timer whose only job is to notice that something has stopped answering, and reset it. That is the cure, it still works twice, and it took a third reader to find — which is why the collision check now reads *every* surface out of the build rather than the ones that existed the day it was written.

FROZEN could not be used for the frozen state, because it is a type name and the chart had just spent real effort making type names carry meaning. HUNG is what the state is anyway.

The box ladder is rights, not sizes, and that is the one item family where the metaphor is allowed to turn unpleasant. A ROOTBOX has unrestricted rights and *no daemon can decline to run on it* — which is the same sentence as “it never fails”, read from the other side.